

Lexington Alarm News Team Guide

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News Portal: <https://lexingtonalarm.org/post-news/>

Understanding Your Role

Role	What Your Button Says	What Happens	Who Reviews
News Team	"PUBLISH STORY"	Story goes live immediately	No review needed
News Contributor	"SUBMIT FOR REVIEW"	Story saved as "Pending"	News Team or Admin approves

News Team Members: Christine, Steve, Toby **News Contributors:** Cindy ReVelle

Submit → Needs approval before publishing

How to Post a Story

Step 1: Go to the Portal

Visit: <https://lexingtonalarm.org/post-news/>

Step 2: Log In

Enter your username and password. Click "Forgot Password?" if needed.

Step 3: Fill In the Form

Field	Required?	Tips
Story Title	 Yes	Clear, descriptive headline
Byline	No	Defaults to your name. Change for reprints only
Upload Image	No	Recommended! Check "Use as Featured Image"
Story Summary	No	2-3 sentences for the news card preview
Full Story	 Yes	Your complete article
Category	 Yes	Choose one (see Featured Story section below)

Step 4: Choose Category

- **Blog Post** = Appears in the "Recent News" grid
- **Featured Story** = Appears prominently at the TOP of the News page (see Featured Story section below)

Step 5: Submit

- **News Team** sees "**PUBLISH STORY**" → Goes live immediately
- **News Contributor** sees "**SUBMIT FOR REVIEW**" → Waits for approval

Editing Stories

Both published stories and the featured summary text can be edited at any time from our news portal. Click on the **Edit** link for the story you want to edit.

In the **Manage Recent Posts** section at the bottom of the portal, you'll see: - List of recent stories with Edit and View links - Click **Edit** to modify any story's title, content, summary, or category - Changes save immediately

Featured Story

The Featured Story appears at the top of our News section and also on our Home page. Generally, Toby determines which story should be featured.

If you need to change the featured story:

Simply check the "Featured Story" box when posting a new story. The system automatically handles the rest—the previous featured story will be moved to a standard blog post automatically.

Note: Only ONE story displays as featured at a time. When you mark a new story as Featured, the old featured story is automatically demoted to Blog Posts.

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Photos

All our posts are better with photos! Use the image upload to add a photo to your story.

Before uploading, make sure: - You have permission to use the photo, OR - The photo is in the public domain (e.g., from Wikipedia, government sources, or similar)

To add a photo: 1. Click "**Choose File**" in the Upload Image field 2. Select your image file 3. Check "**Use as Featured Image**" to make it the main photo for the story 4. The image will display with your published story

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What Happens After You Submit

For News Team Members (Immediate Publish)

1. Story goes live on the News page
2. All team members receive an email notification
3. Done!

For News Contributors (Pending Review)

1. Story saved as "Pending Review"
 2. **Email notification sent** to News Team editors
 3. A News Team member reviews your story
 4. They approve → Story goes live
 5. Or they may contact you for edits
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How to Review & Approve Pending Stories

(For News Team members only)

1. Click the link in the notification email
2. Review the story content
3. Make any edits needed using the Edit link
4. Change status to Published

Managing Your Posts

Below the submission form, you'll see **"Manage Recent Posts"**:

-  Check boxes to select posts
-  Click "Edit" to modify a story
-  Click "View" to see published story
-  "Delete Selected" removes checked posts

What you can manage depends on your role: - **News Team:** All team posts - **News Contributor:** Only your own posts

Auto-Save Feature

Your draft saves automatically as you type!

- Look for: **"✓ Draft auto-saved"** message
- Gray **"SAVE DRAFT"** button for manual save
- If your browser crashes, your draft should be recoverable when you return

Email Notifications

Everyone on the News Team receives an email when: - Any new story is submitted (pending or published) - Subject line tells you if review is needed: - `[ NEEDS REVIEW ]` = Pending approval - `[ New Story Published ]` = Already live

Quick Reference

Workflow for Contributors

```
Write Story → Submit for Review → Wait for Approval → Story Published
      ↓           ↓           ↓
    Portal      Email sent      News Team
                to editors      reviews & approves
```

Workflow for News Team

```
Write Story → Publish → Done!
      ↓           ↓
    Portal      Story live,
                team notified
```

Need Help?

Forgot password? Click "Lost your password?" on login page

Story not appearing? - Contributors: Your story may be waiting for approval - Check with a News Team member

Other issues? Contact Toby

Role Summary

If you are...	You can...	You cannot...
News Team	Publish immediately, edit anyone's posts, approve pending stories	Access WordPress admin settings
News Contributor	Submit stories for review, edit your own drafts	Publish directly, delete posts, edit others' posts

